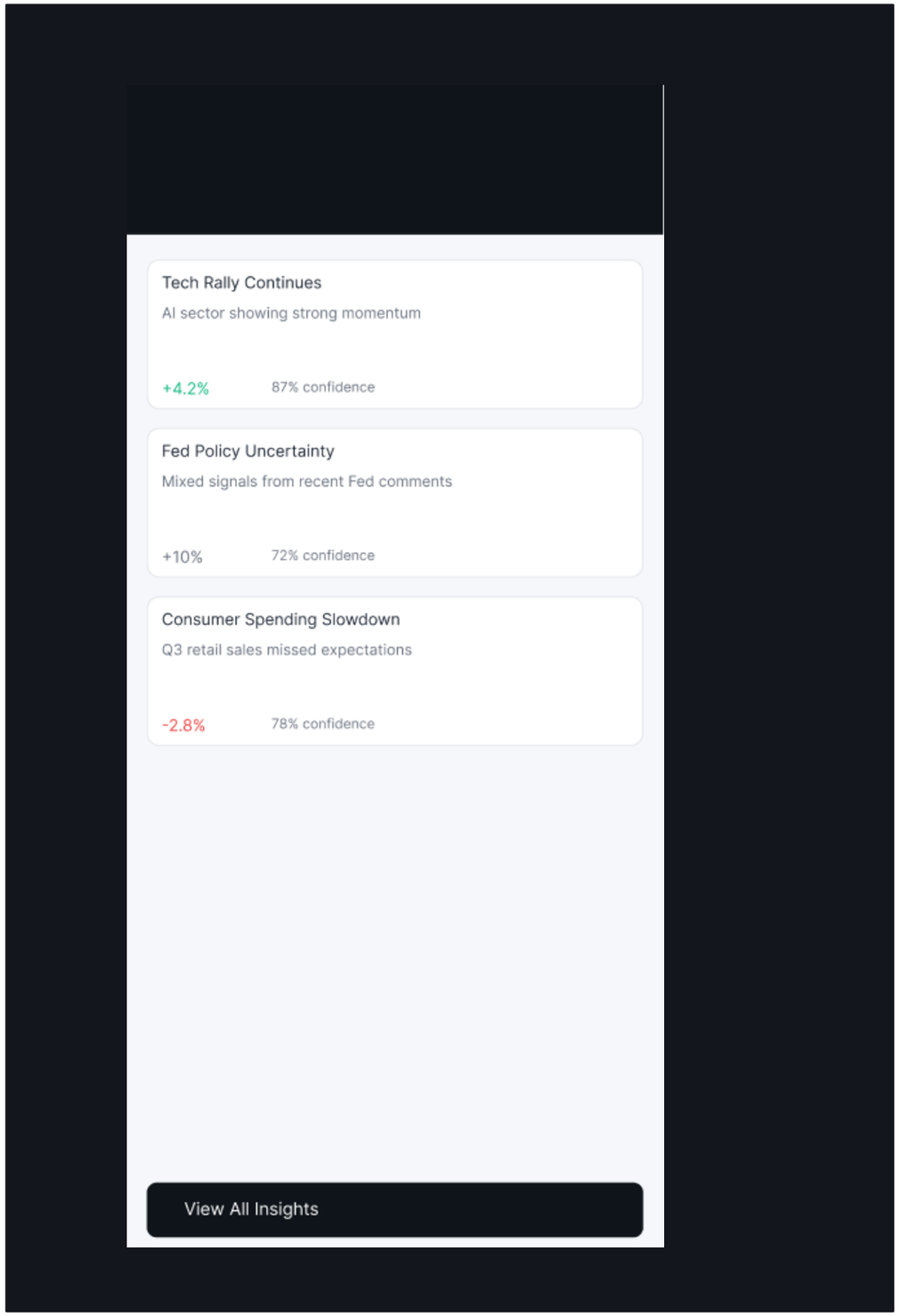
SELECTED WORK · LEAD UX DESIGNER

# Michael Thibodeau

Two projects: an AI screener for active traders, and an AI-assisted mobile trading app.



Contents

# Two projects, one process

Select a project to jump to it.


**01** FinViz AI Screener

Problem, decisions and what comes next

**02** Meridian Navigator

Trade and AI flows, designed states, trade-offs

**03** Leadership and process

How I set direction, the calls, and the status

**04** Next steps

What I would do next

# FinViz: cut sign-up to Elite from 42 days to 21

The target came from the case brief. It has not been measured yet.

**42 → 21**

days from sign-up to Elite, the target for new traders

Measured: not yet. Validation is planned (slide 7).

**PROBLEM**

New traders take 42 days to see why Elite is worth paying for. The screener gives no reasons, and the list forgets them.

**DECISION**

An AI layer turns the trader's own picks into a working screen, and explains each finding with its source.

**RESULT**

Hi-fi concepts for one trading day. Outcome measurement is planned, not done.

# My role, and where the AI stops

I led discovery, strategy and the Figma design. AI agents helped with drafting.

**PROBLEM**

Build a screen from three example tickers, explain why each row matched, and check whether the trader’s reasons still hold.

**DECISION**

The AI verifies the trader’s own criteria. It never originates buy or sell advice. Attributed analyst views sit behind a flag, pending compliance.

**RESULT**

A design that a compliance review can act on, with the advice line written down before the screens were built.

# Decisions, including the ones I reversed

Each call came from a review. The reasoning is kept in the full deck.

DECISION 1

## No chat box first

Imports and examples lead. Success must be timely, relevant and actionable.

DECISION 2

## Set the advice line

The AI never originates advice. Attributed analyst views sit behind a flag, pending compliance.

DECISION 3

## Lead with the trading day

Three concepts competed. The one that followed his real routine won.

DECISION 4

## Map today’s onboarding first

A live-site walk found an existing 7-day trial and 1-minute delayed quotes. Two assumptions were wrong.

# Leadership: how I set direction and made calls

Evidence from the project record, with dates where the record has them.

### SET THE DIRECTION

Logged 31 points from a four-reviewer review on 30 Sept. The organizing goal moved to time to first success.

### RECONCILED, NOT OVERWRITTEN

Teammates' screens kept their best ideas. Only what broke the rules was cut.

### MADE THE CALLS, DATED

Lead calls on 23 and 30 Sept, each written with its reason: no chat box first, set the advice line, lead with the trading day.

### KEPT OPEN DECISIONS VISIBLE

Meridian: open questions and decisions logged on the FigJam board, and settled items marked separately.

### SET THE RULES ONCE

Rules in the project brief made every AI draft start compliant.

# What I would validate next

Planned, not run. Nothing here is a result yet.

1

## Think-aloud

5 users, on the first evening and the board

2

## Alert diary study

Two weeks of real alerts, logged by participants

3

## Labeled chart checks

Weekly audits, with a target of under 1% wrong among clear detections

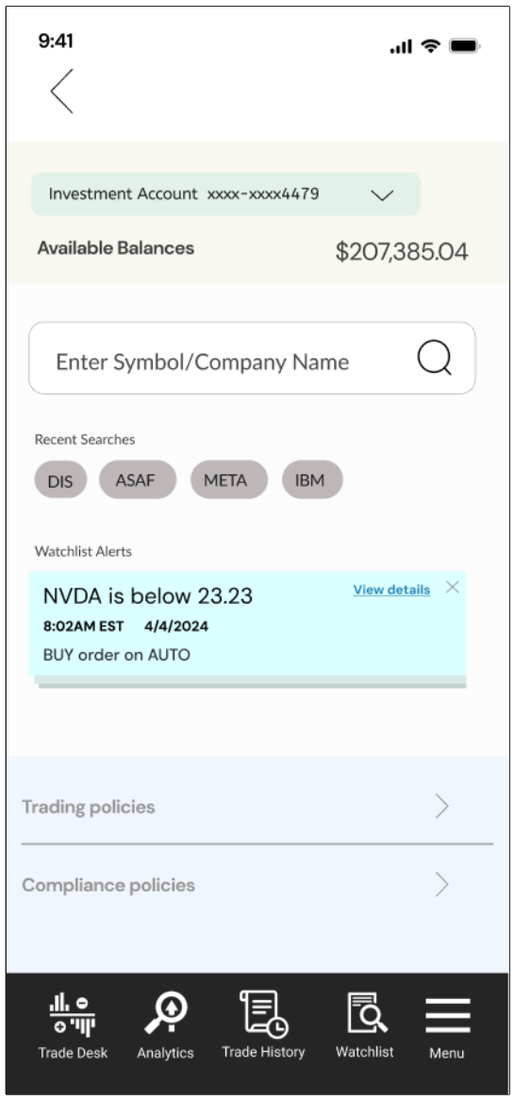
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## Compliance review

The advice line and the trial timing, before any launch

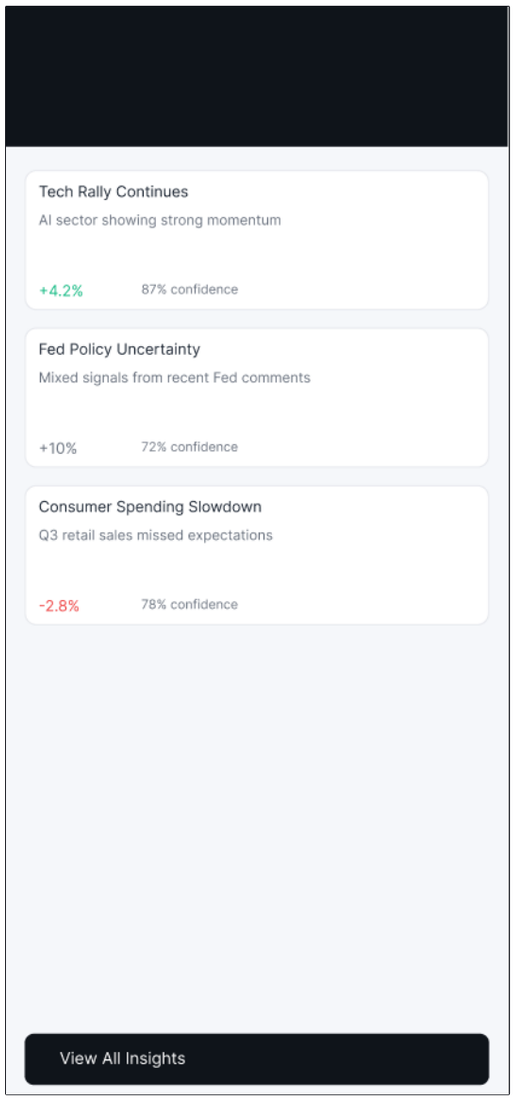
# Meridian: a trade and AI flow, prototyped in Figma

Five core screens, each answering one question. Outcomes are not yet measured.



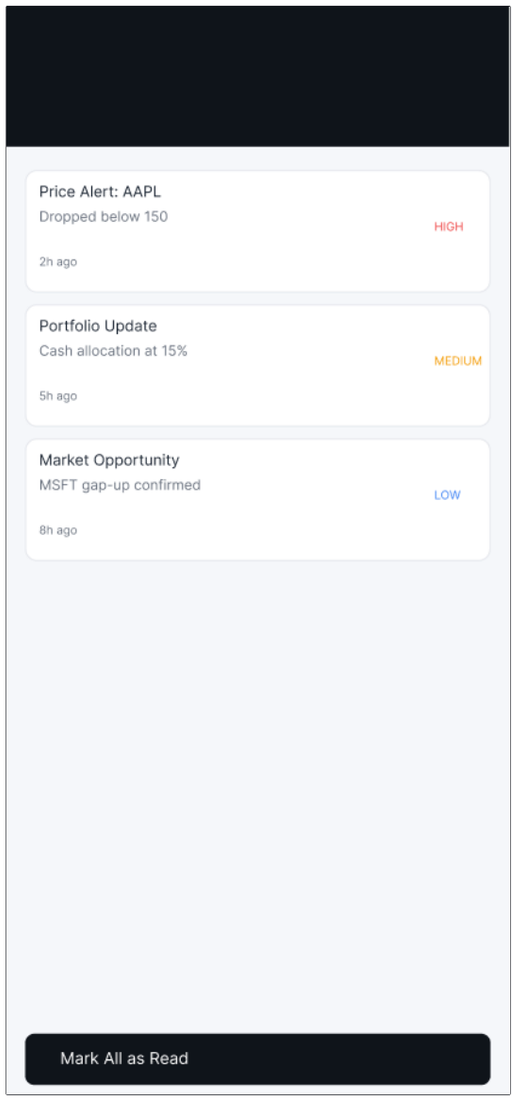

## Dashboard

What do I own today?




## Insight

What moved, and why?




## Guard

What needs my attention?

**PROBLEM**

Research, order entry and monitoring live in separate tools.

**DECISION**

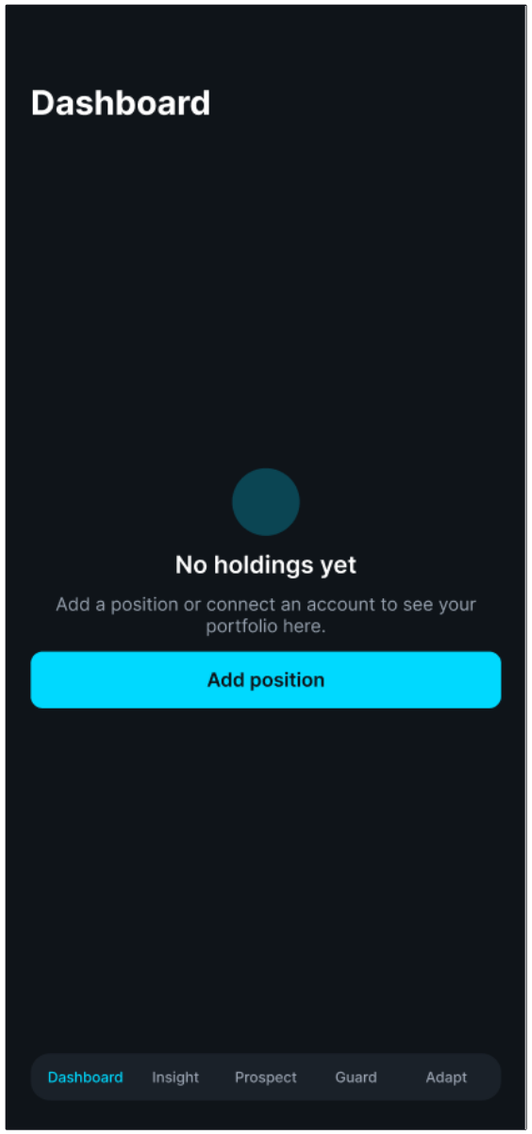
Put trade flows and AI screens in one app, with mock data.

**RESULT**

A clickable prototype. Outcomes not yet measured.

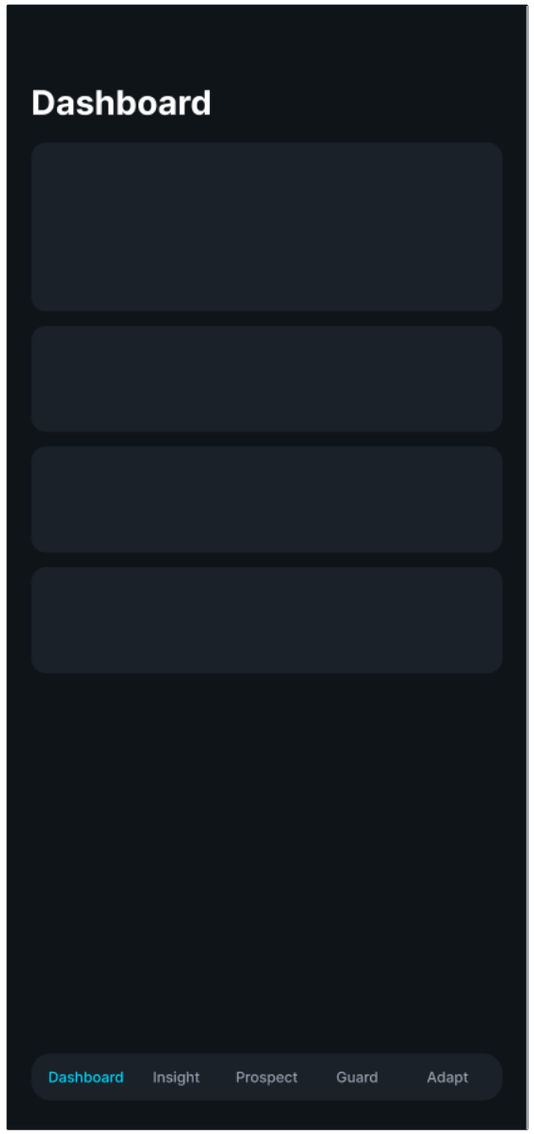
# Designing for the states that mocked data hides

Dashboard in four states. The other four screens follow the same pattern.



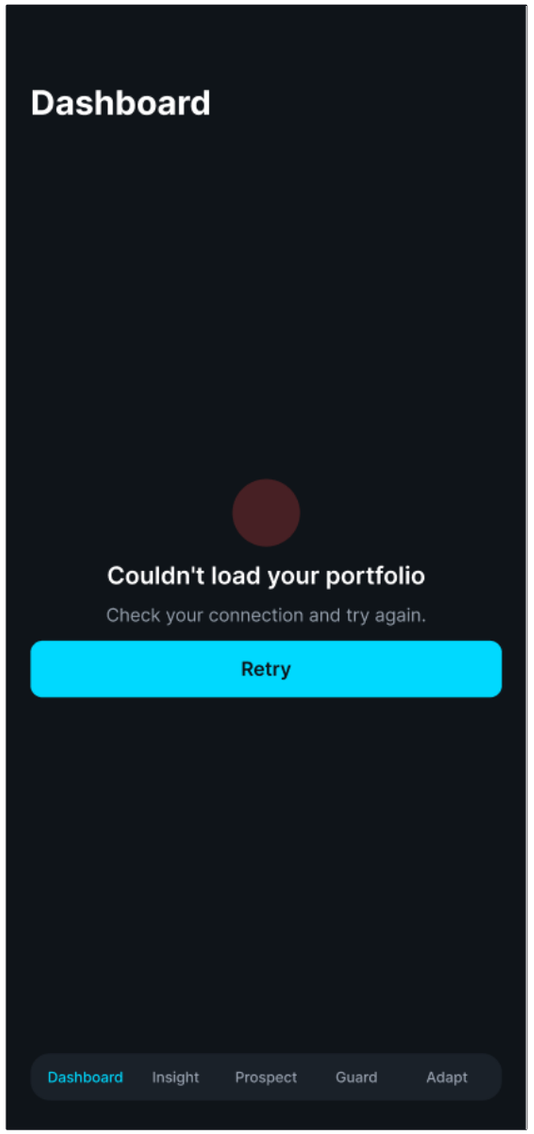

## Empty

No holdings yet. One clear next step.



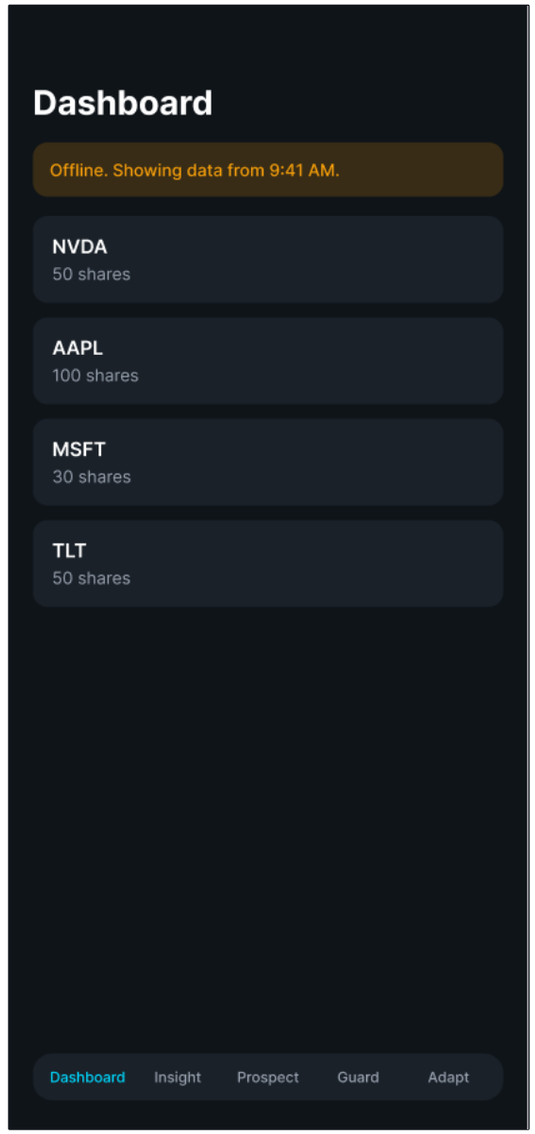

## Loading

Skeleton cards hold the layout while data loads.




## Error

Says what failed and offers a retry.




## Offline

Warns that data is stale and shows the last update.

# Trade-offs I chose, and what they cost

Each call is stated with its cost. Open items are marked as open.

DECISION 1

## Keep both share and dollar entry

Unclear which model new investors prefer. Two flows to maintain, and open for testing.

DECISION 2

## Mock API with a delay

Lets us test flows and loading states without a backend. Real timing and errors are untested.

DECISION 3

## Adapt suggests buys and sells

It is the screen’s job, but the wording needs compliance review before release.

DECISION 4

## Five tabs, one home screen

Scannable areas, with trading one tap away. AI screens compete with trade entry for attention.

# How I work, across both projects

Self-assessed status. No interviews or usability tests have run yet.

1

## Frame

DONE

Problem, scope and assumptions written down before design.

2

## Hypothesize

DRAFTED

Personas and principles, marked as untested.

3

## Map flows

DRAFTED

Flows and screens for the core job, drafted in Figma.

4

## Design system

IN PROGRESS

Shared tokens for Figma and code. Component library not yet audited.

5

## Design states

DRAFTED

Empty, loading, error and offline states.

6

## Validate

PLANNED

Interviews, usability tests and compliance review.

# Accessibility, handoff, and working with teams

What is specified, what is in place, and what has not been checked yet.

### ACCESSIBILITY

Specified: WCAG 2.2 AA in the FinViz design system (4.5:1 text contrast, 24px targets), and WCAG AA with ARIA labels in Meridian. Not audited.

### HANDOFF

In place: colors and spacing are defined as tokens in the design system, and the Figma file uses the same navy and cyan values. Not verified: a live sync between Figma and SwiftUI.

### TEAMS AND COMPLIANCE

Reviews: four reviewers commented on the FinViz boards on 30 Sept. Open: the advice line is waiting on compliance review. Day-to-day work with PMs and engineers is not documented in the project files.

# An AI that shows its reasoning and waits for approval

Adapt becomes a plan the user steers. Insight shows its evidence. Each order carries its reason. Mock data throughout.

**PROBLEM**

Insight shows conclusions without evidence. Adapt is approve-or-dismiss for a batch of trades. Dismissals teach nothing. Orders lose their reason.

**DECISION**

Goal to plan, with editable steps. Visible autonomy levels. Evidence on every output. Orders that carry their reason. A reviewable list of learned rules.

**RESULT**

Clickable Figma wireframes for the plan, review, evidence and learned-rules flows. Effects are planned measures, not results.

Next steps

# What I would do next

The order that unblocks the most work.

- Run five to eight interviews to test the personas
- Usability-test the share and dollar flows
- Set metric targets with stakeholders and measure them
- Complete the compliance review of trade and AI copy

## Get in touch

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